

# Euro 2028 Predictor — Admin Scenario Runner / Simulated Results Brief

## Purpose

The Euro 2028 Predictor already has, or is planned to have, an Admin fake clock for testing tournament phases.

A fake clock alone is not enough.

The app also needs a safe Admin-controlled way to apply simulated/fake results based on the selected tournament phase, fake date/time, or chosen match checkpoint.

This is needed so the team can test the full tournament lifecycle without manually entering every result through the proper official result-entry section.

## Core idea

Admin should be able to choose exactly how far through the tournament to simulate.

Examples:

- simulate up to the first match;
- simulate through today's fake-clock time;
- simulate to the end of the group stage;
- simulate to the start of the knockouts;
- simulate through Round of 16;
- simulate through Quarter-finals;
- simulate through Semi-finals;
- simulate to full tournament complete.

The simulated result state should then allow the app to be tested as if the tournament had genuinely progressed.

## Name

Suggested feature name:

Admin Scenario Runner

Alternative labels:

- Tournament Simulator
- Scenario Results
- Test Tournament Progression
- Simulation Control

## **Hard boundary**

This is not normal official result entry.

It must be separate from the proper result-entry/admin results section.

Simulated results are for staging/testing only.

They must not be confused with official real tournament results.

They must not touch WC26 production.

## **Why this is needed**

A fake clock can test time-based states, but it cannot fully test result-dependent states.

The Scenario Runner is needed to test:

- Home pre-lock, live, between-match, end-of-day and rest-day states;
- Results page;
- Match Centre;
- group table calculation;
- best third-place qualification;
- real knockout bracket generation;
- KO Predictor readiness;
- Original Bracket Health;
- user bracket versus real bracket alignment;
- Prediction Trends live tournament state;
- scoring and leaderboard updates;
- full tournament completion.

## **Admin controls**

The Scenario Runner should support two ways to simulate.

### **1. Simulate by fake clock**

Admin sets a fake date/time, then runs:

Apply simulated results up to fake clock

The app applies simulated results for every match scheduled before or at that fake time.

## 2. Simulate by match/checkpoint

Admin can choose a specific checkpoint.

Suggested checkpoints:

| Checkpoint               | Purpose                                            |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Pre-tournament locked    | Test locked Home / Review read-only                |
| First match live         | Test live Home / Match Centre                      |
| After first match        | Test first result / points update                  |
| End of matchday          | Test day recap                                     |
| End of group matchday 1  | Test partial group tables                          |
| End of group stage       | Test final group tables and qualifiers             |
| Round of 16 generated    | Test real KO bracket readiness                     |
| Round of 16 complete     | Test Bracket Health and QF path                    |
| Quarter-finals complete  | Test bracket survival                              |
| Semi-finals complete     | Test finalists                                     |
| Final complete           | Test tournament complete                           |
| Full tournament complete | Test final standings and Prediction Trends archive |

Admin should also be able to choose:

Simulate up to Match [number]

This allows exact testing of any tournament point.

## Required behaviours

When simulated results are applied, the app should behave as if those matches have completed.

The simulation should feed the same downstream product behaviour as official results, including:

- Results page;

- Home matchday state;
- Match Centre state;
- group tables;
- best third-place ranking;
- knockout bracket progression;
- Bracket Health;
- Original Predictor scoring;
- KO Predictor readiness;
- KO Predictor scoring where relevant;
- leaderboards;
- Prediction Trends;
- Player View and Points Breakdown.

This is the only way to properly test full tournament progression.

## Live match simulation

The Scenario Runner should support at least one live-match state.

For example:

Match 12 live at 63 minutes

or:

Set fake clock to during Match 12

This allows testing:

- live Home row;
- Match Centre live state;
- live Results state;
- between-match transition;
- finished transition.

Live simulation does not need to be overly complex at first. A simple live status with score/time is enough for first pass.

## Simulated score source

Simulated scores should be deterministic, not random every time.

A good first version could use a fixed scenario file or deterministic scenario generator.

Example scenario types:

| Scenario                 | Purpose                            |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Favourites win           | Tests expected bracket             |
| Mixed results            | Tests realistic tables             |
| Upset-heavy              | Tests bracket damage               |
| Draw-heavy groups        | Tests tiebreaks                    |
| High-scoring             | Tests group-goals and goals trends |
| Low-scoring              | Tests group-goals bands            |
| Penalty-heavy knockouts  | Tests KO method scoring            |
| Full tournament complete | Tests final archive state          |

For first pass, one deterministic default scenario is enough.

## Safety requirements

The Scenario Runner must be safe.

### 1. Staging only

It must fail closed outside Euro staging/local development.

It must never touch WC26 production.

### 2. Separate from official entry

Simulated results must not be entered through, or confused with, the official result-entry flow.

### 3. Clear source marker

Every simulated result should be marked clearly as simulated.

Possible fields/concepts:

```
source = simulation
is_simulated = true
scenario_id = default_scenario
```

Use whatever fits the existing schema/model. Do not create a migration unless a genuine schema gap is proved and explicitly approved.

#### 4. Reset/clear simulation

Admin must be able to clear simulated results and return to a clean pre-results state.

Suggested controls:

Clear simulated results  
Reset scenario  
Return to pre-tournament state

#### 5. No accidental official publish

There must be no path where simulated scores become official production results by mistake.

#### 6. Audit trail

Admin should be able to see:

- scenario applied;
- applied by;
- fake clock time;
- match checkpoint;
- timestamp;
- reset/clear action.

This can be admin-only.

### Result correction rule

Matches should not normally need corrected in the real product.

Result correction is not a planned everyday user-facing feature.

However, the Scenario Runner may need reset/reapply controls for testing. That is different from public result correction.

Simulation reset/reapply should remain admin/testing-only and should not create normal user-facing correction behaviour.

### Relationship with fake clock

The fake clock and Scenario Runner should work together.

Fake clock controls the perceived tournament time.

Scenario Runner controls which simulated results exist at that perceived time.

Ideal flow:

1. Admin chooses fake date/time.
2. Admin chooses scenario or checkpoint.
3. Admin applies simulated results up to that fake date/time or match.
4. App updates as if tournament has progressed.
5. Admin reviews Home, Results, Match Centre, Bracket Health, Prediction Trends and Leaderboards.
6. Admin clears simulation when done.

## Relationship with candidate team pool

The Scenario Runner should work well with the candidate team pool / draw-slot assignment model.

If real teams are assigned to slots, simulated results should use those teams.

If slots are still unresolved, simulated results may use slot labels for testing.

Do not hardcode fake team names directly into scenario results if slot assignment can provide realistic teams.

## No migration unless proved

This feature should first inspect the current schema/source to see what is already possible.

Do not create Migration 019 unless there is a genuine schema/read-contract gap and the user explicitly approves it.

Prefer:

- existing result tables;
- existing admin/staging controls;
- existing fake clock/test-mode flags;
- existing audit models;
- local deterministic scenario files.

## Suggested stage name

STAGE-ADMIN-SCENARIO-RUNNER-1

## Suggested first-pass scope

First pass should be controlled and useful.

Minimum first-pass scope:

1. Inspect current fake clock/admin controls.
2. Inspect current result-entry and scoring flow.
3. Confirm the safest way to apply simulated results in Euro staging/local only.
4. Add a deterministic default scenario.
5. Add "simulate up to match/checkpoint" controls.
6. Add "simulate up to fake clock" control if feasible.
7. Add "clear simulated results" control.
8. Ensure simulated results trigger group tables, knockout progression, scoring, Home, Match Centre, Bracket Health and Prediction Trends where those surfaces exist.
9. Ensure no WC26 production access.
10. Ensure no Migration 019 unless explicitly approved.

## Acceptance criteria

The stage is complete only if:

- fake clock and simulated results can be used together;
- Admin can simulate to a chosen match/checkpoint;
- Admin can simulate to fake-clock time where feasible;
- Admin can clear/reset simulated results;
- simulated results do not use the proper official result-entry path as a manual workaround;
- simulated results are clearly separate from official results;
- Home reflects the simulated phase correctly;
- end-of-group-stage can be tested;
- knockout readiness can be tested;
- Original Bracket Health can be tested against simulated real progression;
- full tournament complete can be tested;
- Original and KO Predictor points remain separate;
- no schema migration is created unless explicitly approved;
- WC26 production remains untouched.

## Summary

The Admin fake clock should be paired with an Admin Scenario Runner.

The fake clock controls time.

The Scenario Runner controls simulated results.

Together, they let the app be tested at any tournament phase, including:

```
pre-lock  
first match live  
end of group stage
```

knockout bracket generated  
bracket health active  
full tournament complete

This is essential for testing the app properly before the real tournament without manually entering every score through the official result-entry section.